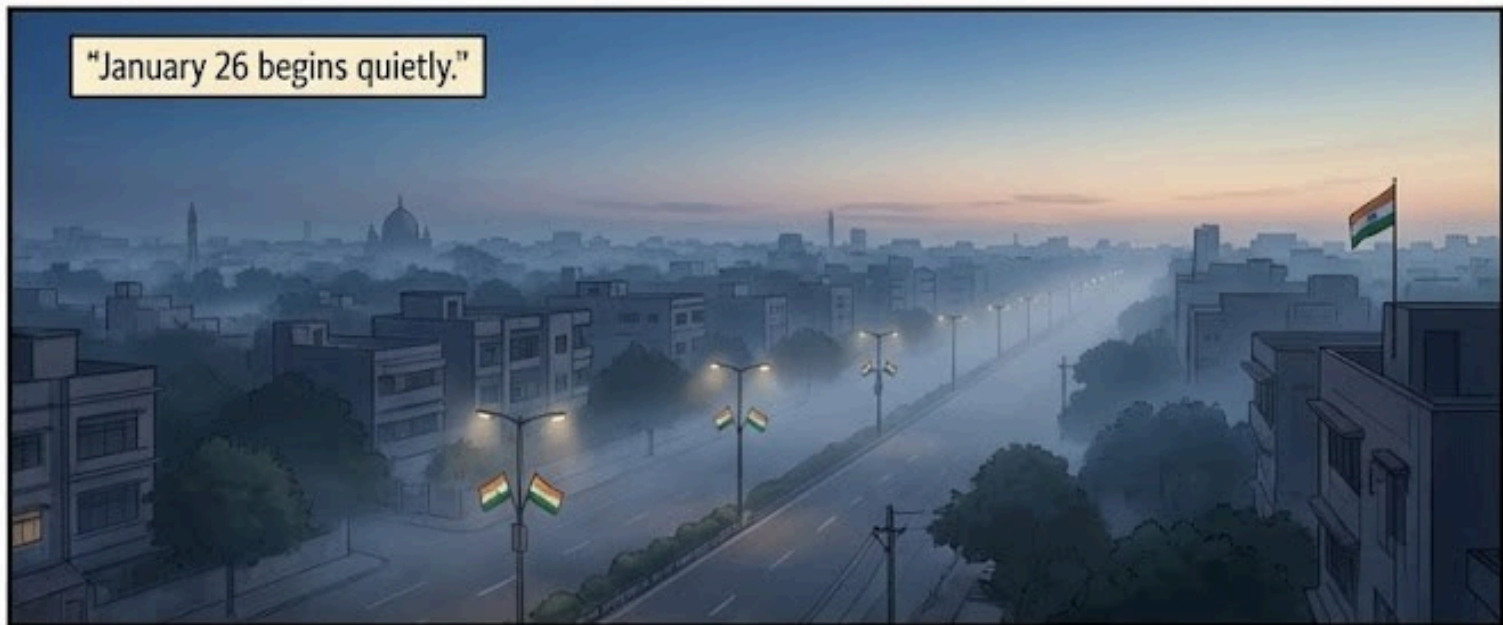


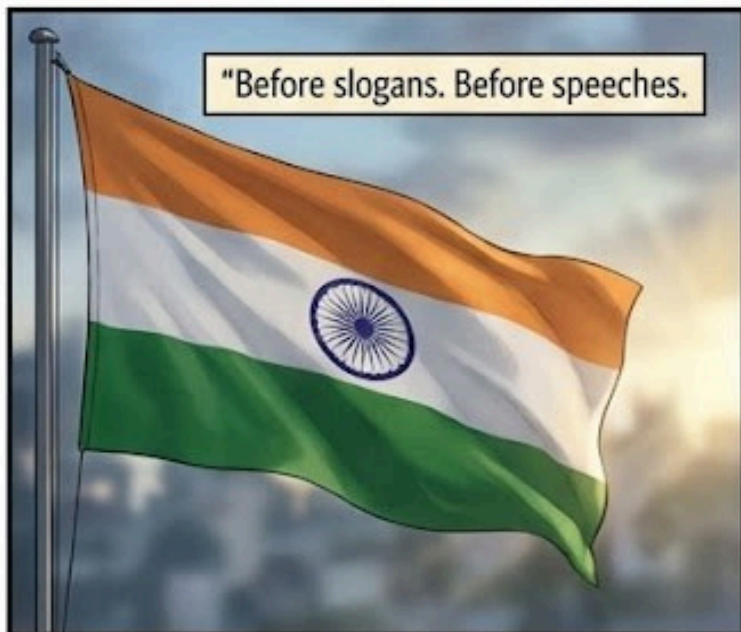
TRICOLOR SHADOWS



"January 26 begins quietly."



"Before slogans. Before speeches."



REPUBLIC DAY

Look! My flag is perfect!

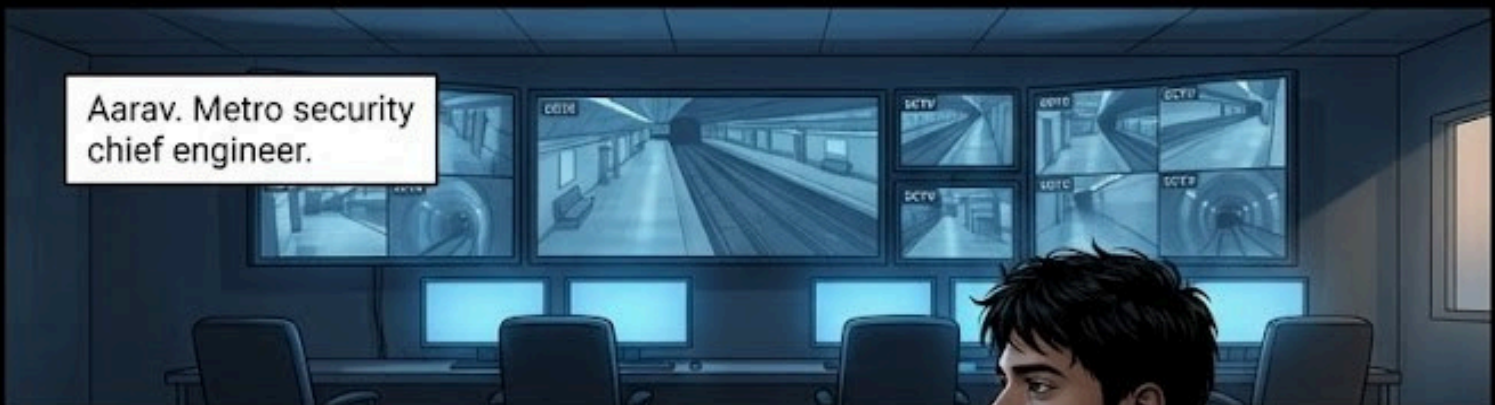


"Some traditions breathe through generations."



"And some responsibilities begin early."



A wide shot of a control room. Aarav is seated at a desk with multiple computer monitors. The monitors display various CCTV feeds of a subway station. The room is dimly lit, with the primary light source being the screens.

Aarav. Metro security
chief engineer.

A medium shot of Aarav sitting at his desk. He is holding a steaming cup of coffee in his right hand. He is looking towards the left, where several monitors are displaying CCTV footage. The scene is quiet and focused.

He watches
the city wake up.

A close-up profile shot of Aarav. He has a thoughtful expression, looking off to the side. The background is blurred, showing the same control room environment.

Aarav (thought):
"Another Republic Day..."

A close-up of the desk in front of Aarav. In the center is a steaming cup of coffee. To the left is a spiral-bound notebook with a pen resting on it. To the right is a blue lanyard with an ID card attached. The ID card has a silhouette of a person and some text.

Ordinary work.
Extraordinary weight.

A close-up of a round analog clock mounted on a wall. The clock face is white with black numbers and hands. The time shown is approximately 7:10 AM.

He doesn't know
today will test him.



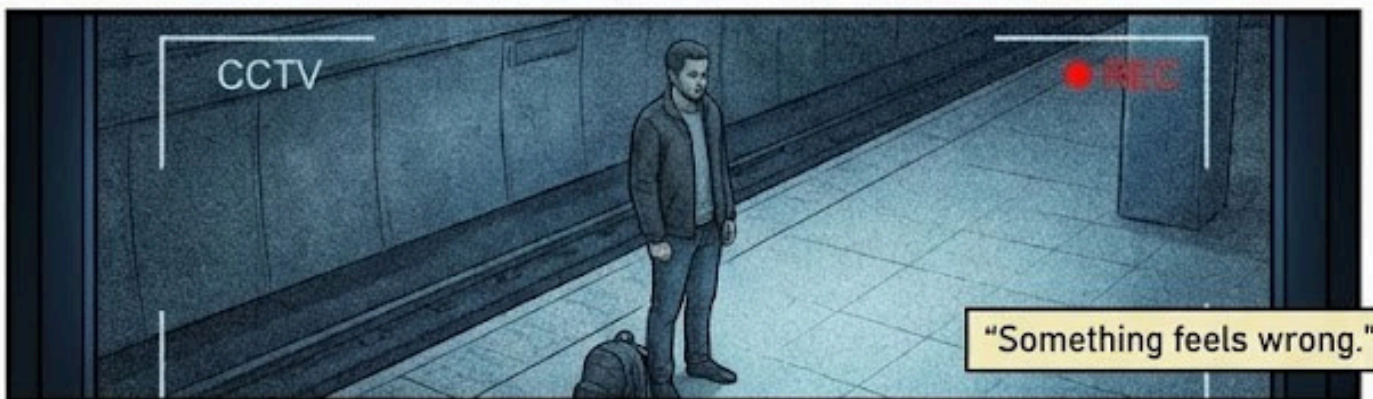
"Why is he standing so still?"



"Instinct whispers before danger screams."



"That bag..."



"Something feels wrong."



Power fails.



Screens die.



This can't be coincidence.

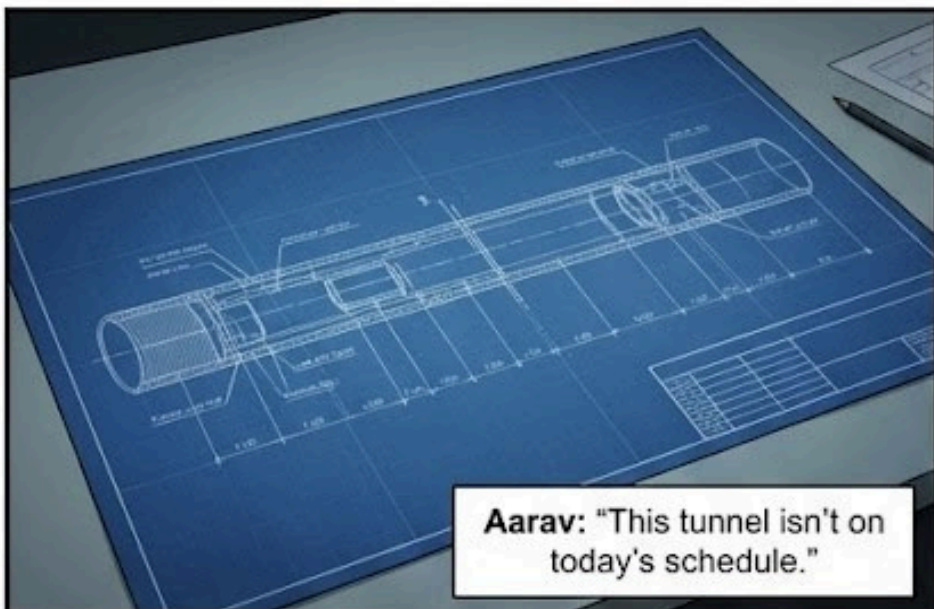


Emergency lights flicker.



I'm on my own.





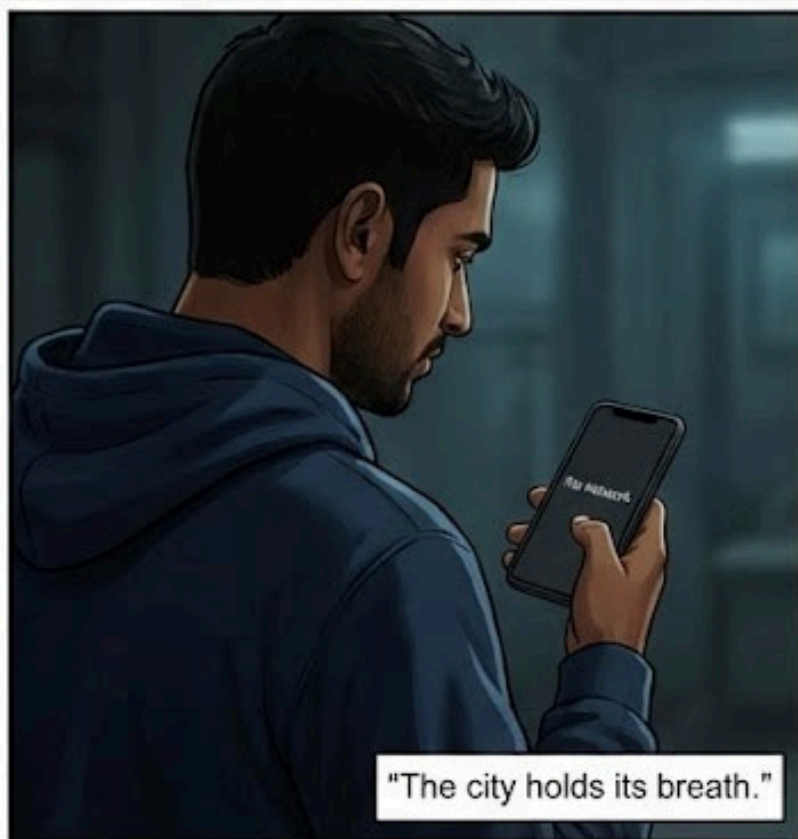
Aarav: "This tunnel isn't on today's schedule."



"Unauthorized signal detected."



Aarav (thought):
"Who opened this gate?"



"The city holds its breath."



Aarav:
"No network?"

"Silence spreads faster than fear."

Years ago...



"Republic Day isn't a holiday, son."



"It's a reminder."

"A reminder to stand."

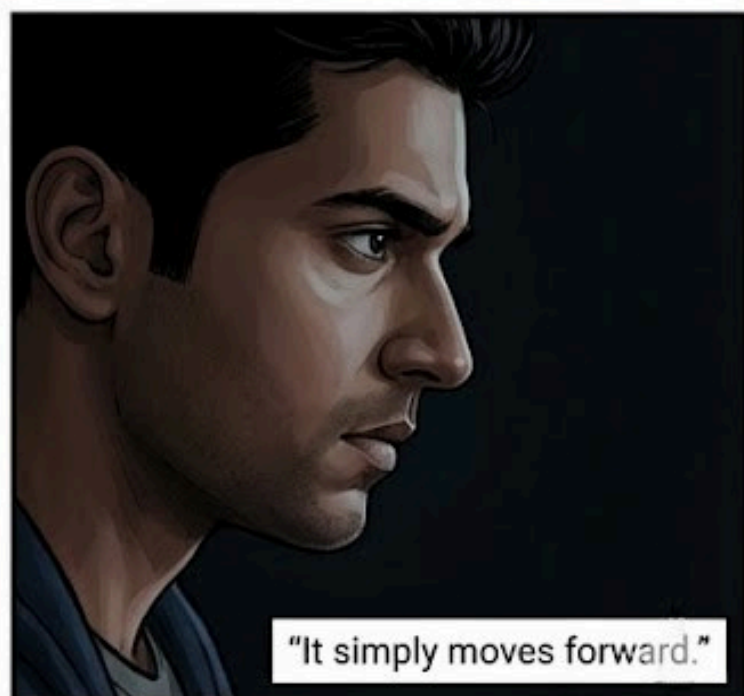


"A reminder to stand."



"Some lessons wait for the right moment."





"Below the celebration..."



"Darkness waits."



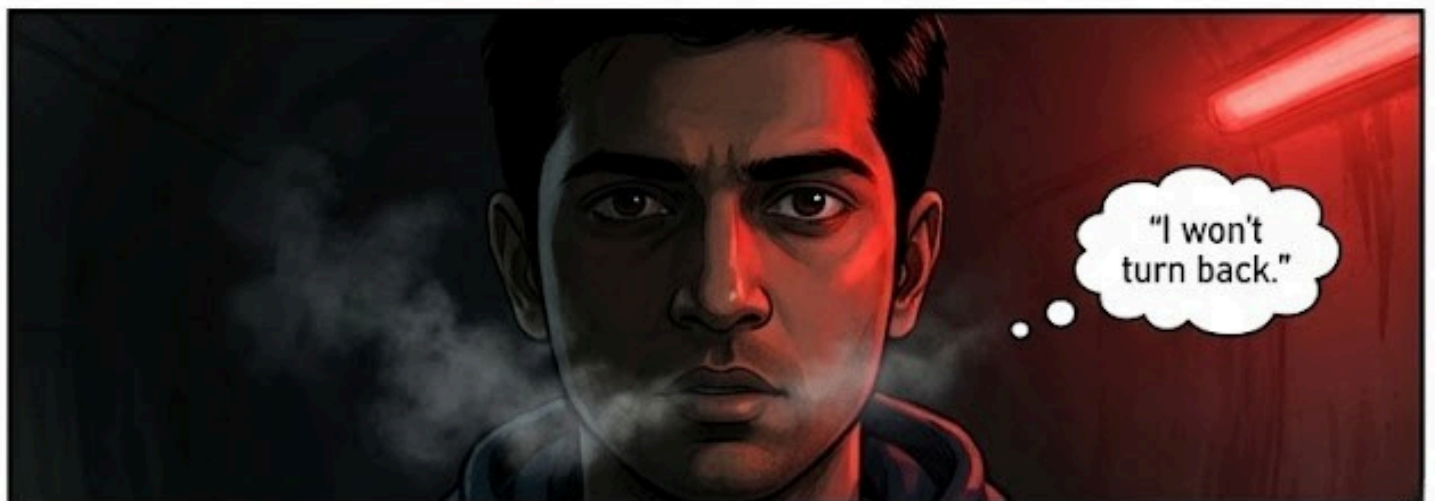
"Stay calm."

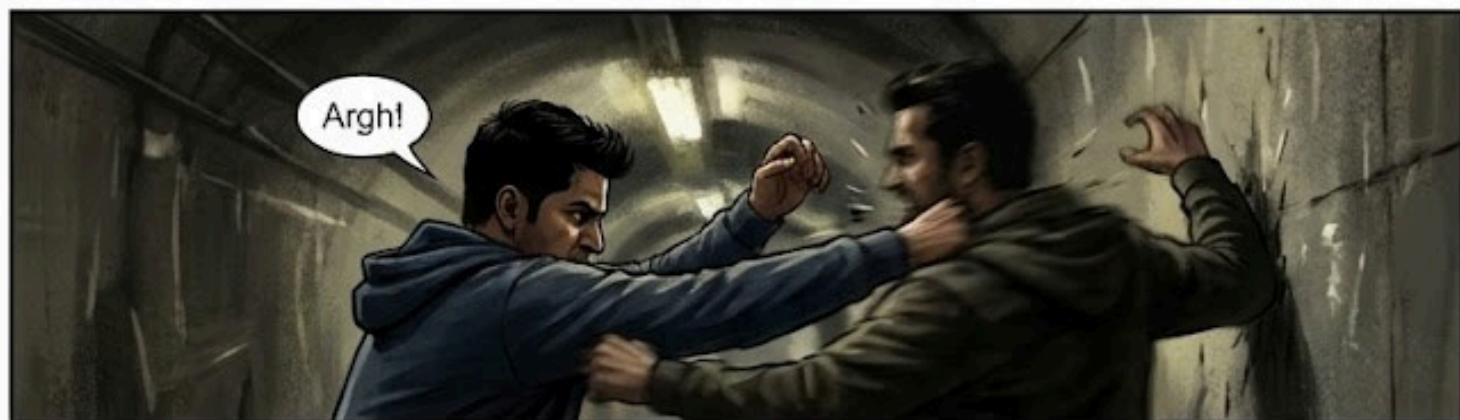
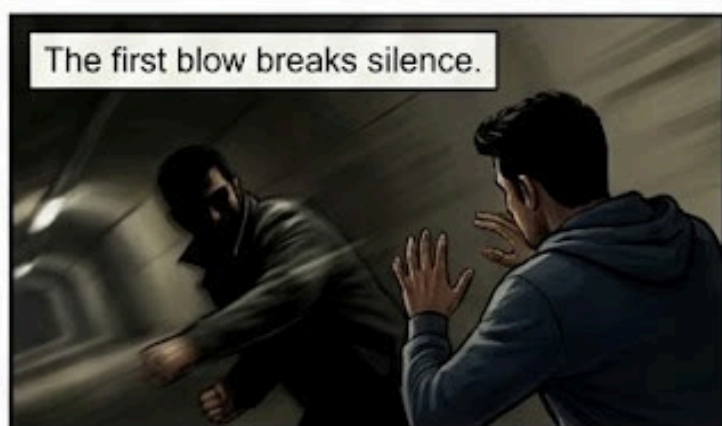


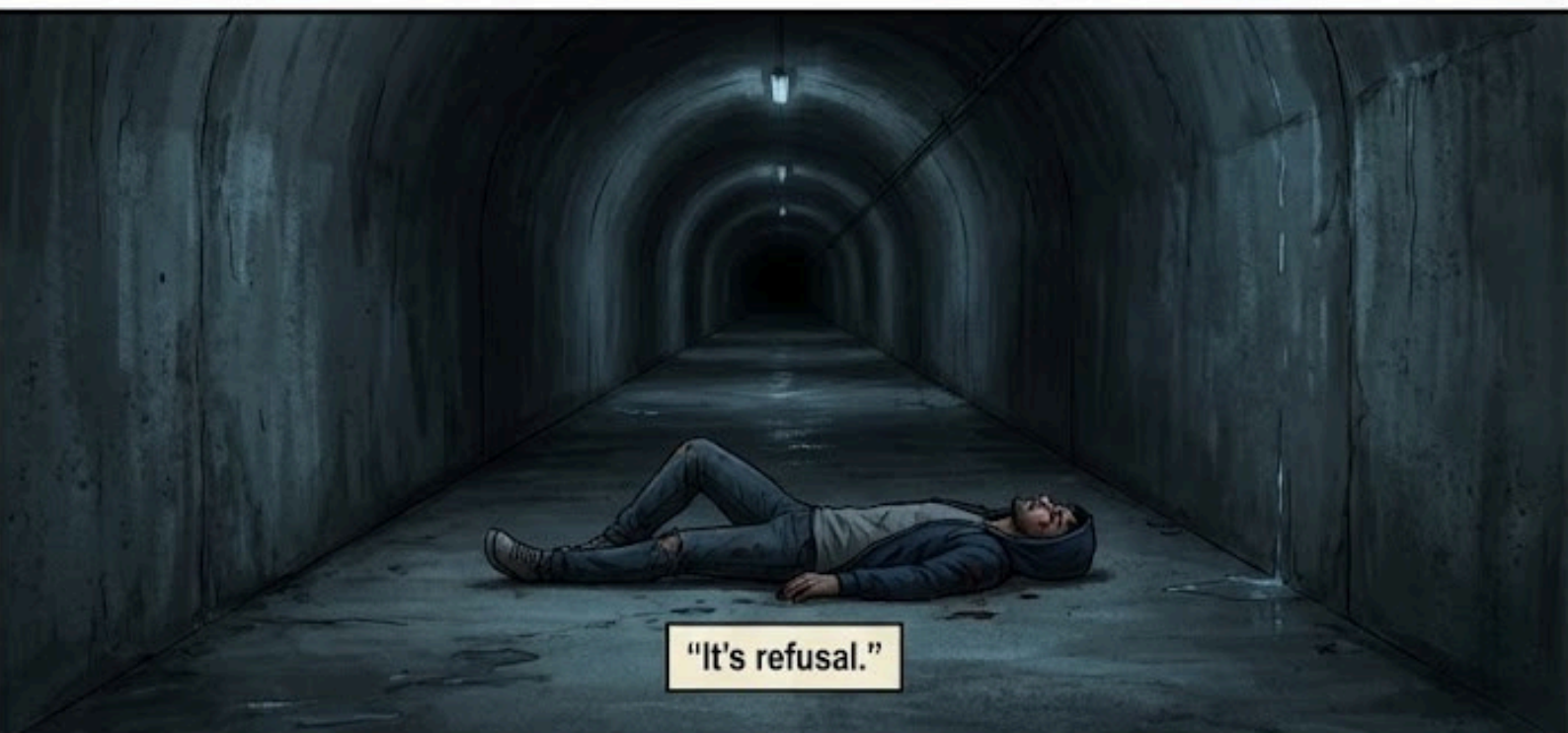
"Every step echoes responsibility."



"I won't turn back."







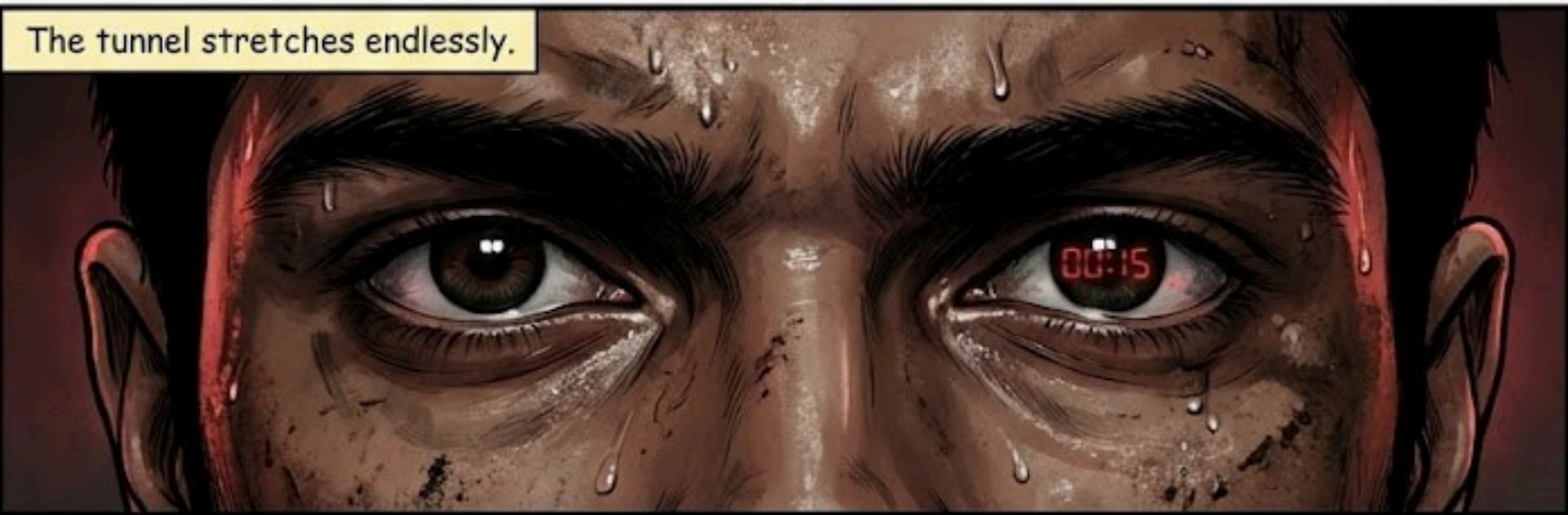
Pain slows the body.



But not the purpose.



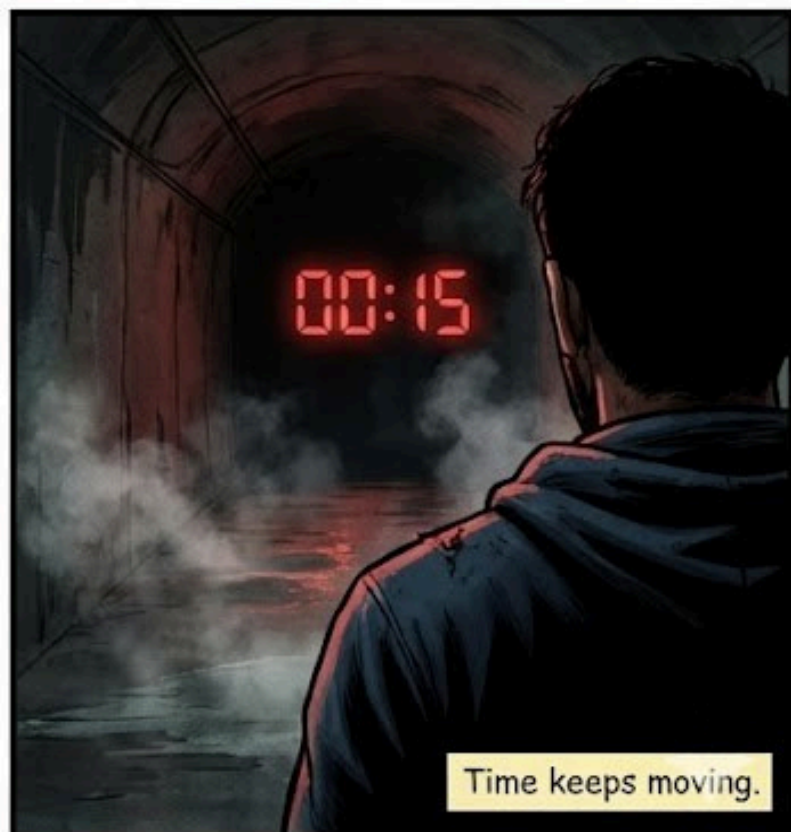
The tunnel stretches endlessly.



Just a little more.

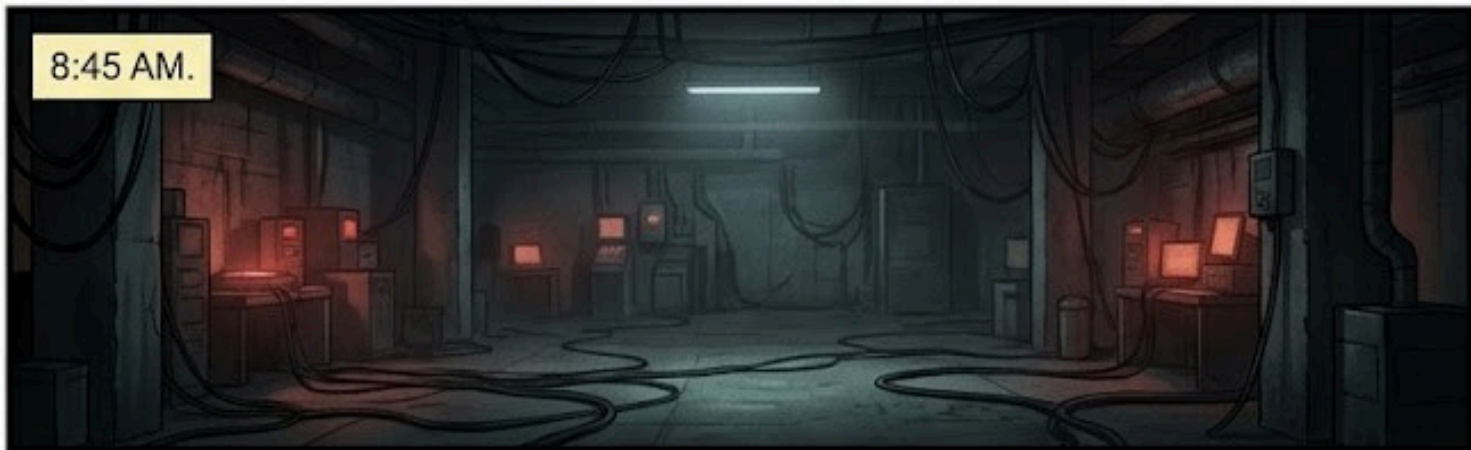


00:15



Time keeps moving.

8:45 AM.



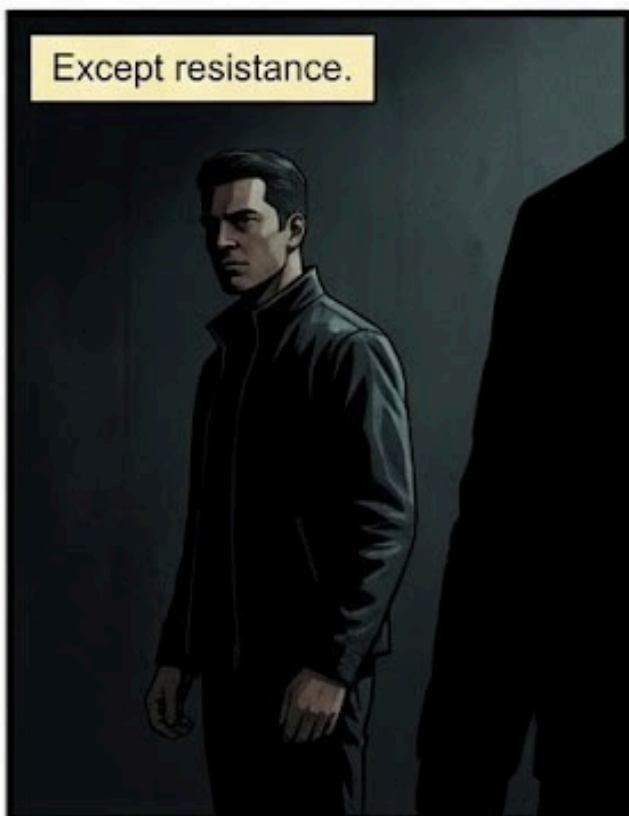
Fifteen minutes to chaos.



They planned everything.



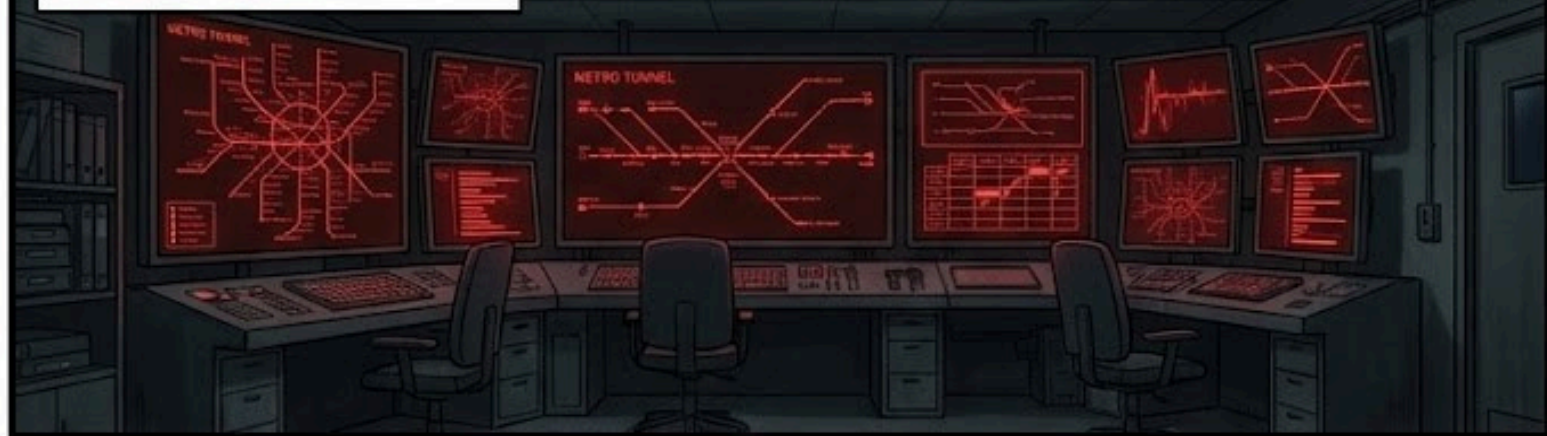
Except resistance.



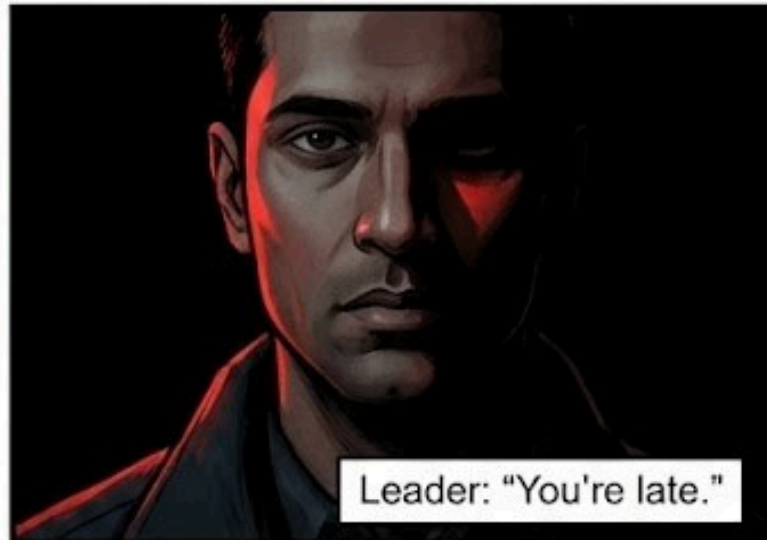
I won't let this happen.



They don't shout slogans.



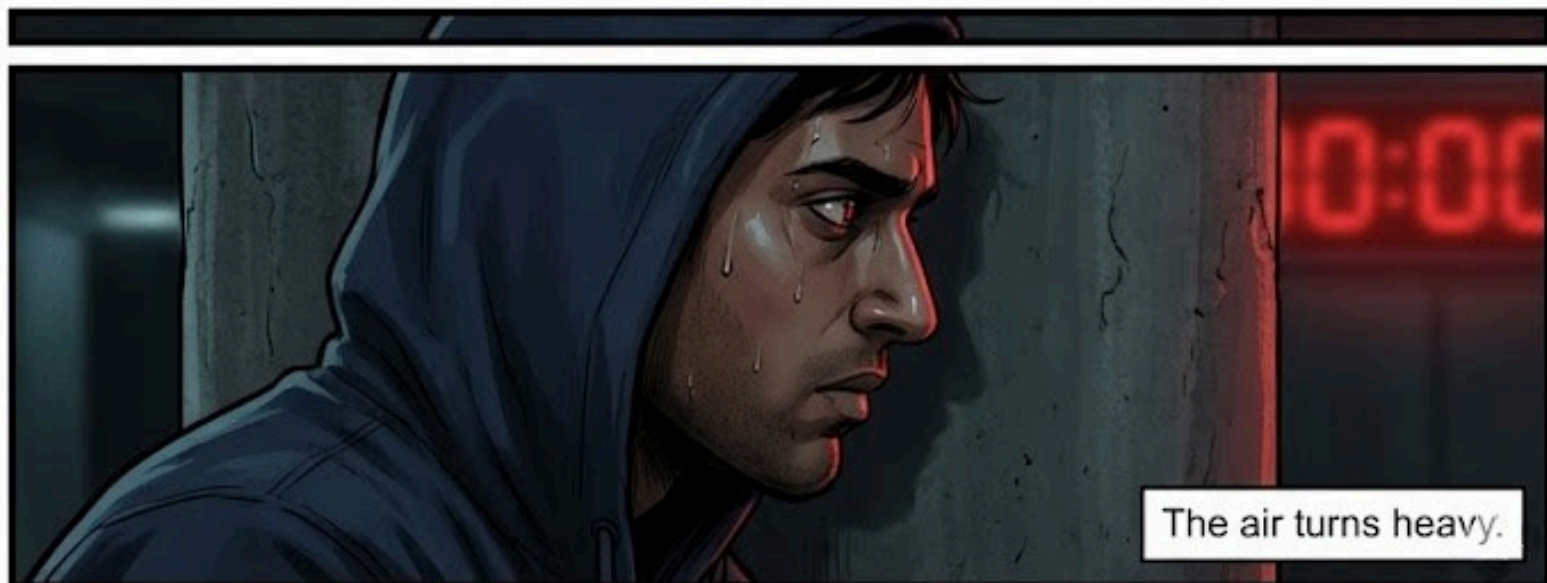
They trade in fear.



Leader: "You're late."



Aarav: "I'm right on time."



The air turns heavy.

Leader: "One switch...
and panic spreads."

A Shadow Cell operative
toward unseen threat.

Aarav: "You won't touch it."

Leader: "You think this country
cares about you?"

LIVE

LIVE

Leader: "You think this country cares?"

Aarav: "It doesn't have to."

Belief stands taller than fear.

The first strike comes fast.



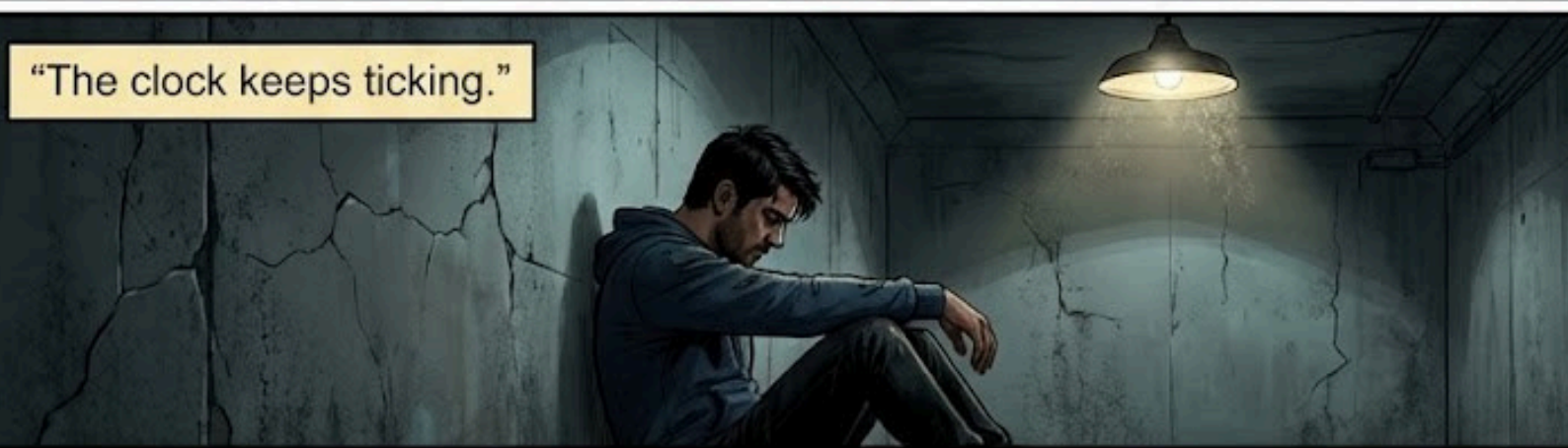
"His body gives up."



"Not yet."



"The clock keeps ticking."



Leader: "You can't stop what's coming."



"But he still stands."





"This nation survives
on illusion."



"Break one morning...
and it crumbles."



"You're
wrong."



"It survives
on people."



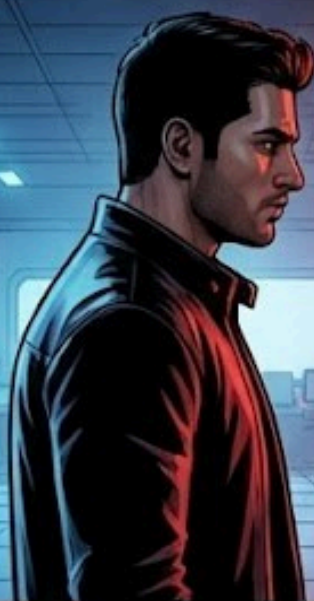
Silence answers back.

8:58 AM.



Two minutes left.

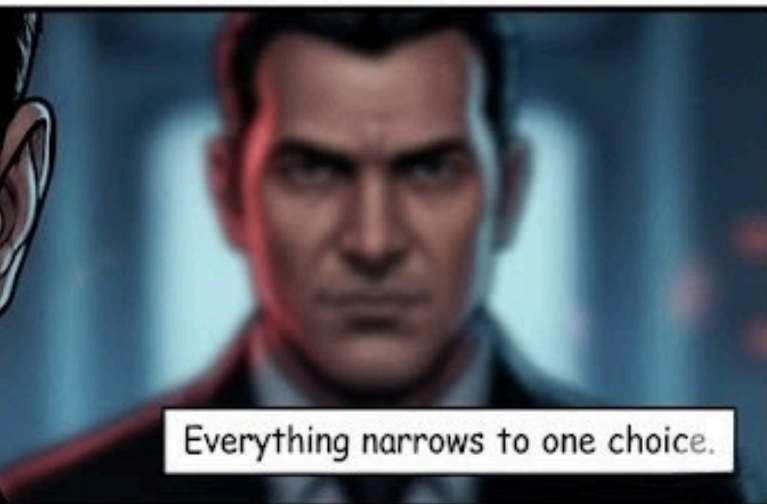
Leader:
Last chance.



For you.



Everything narrows to one choice.



Pain becomes irrelevant.



If this is
the cost...



...I'll pay it.



Now!



Light explodes.



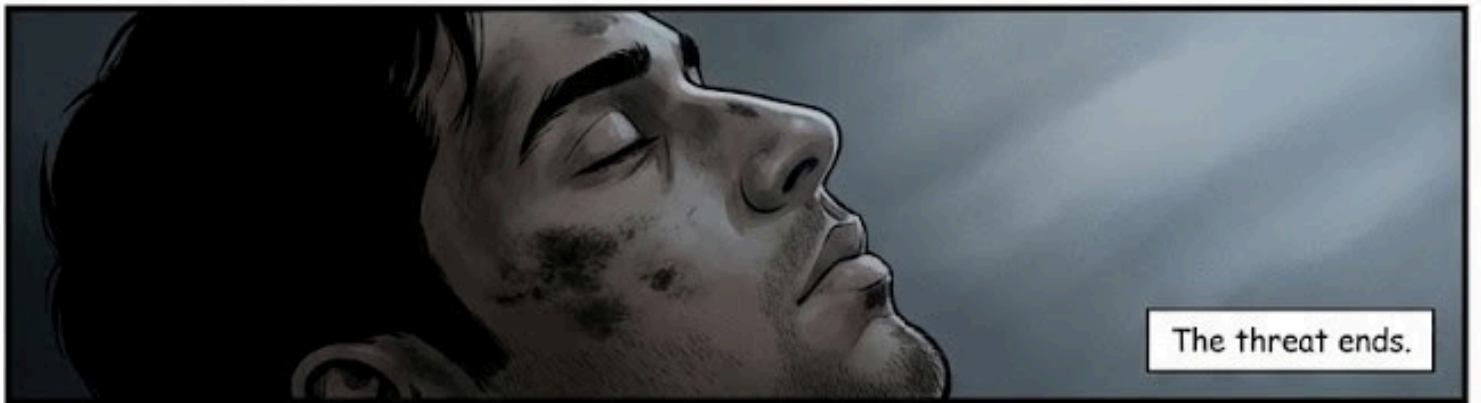
The system shuts down.



The device dies.



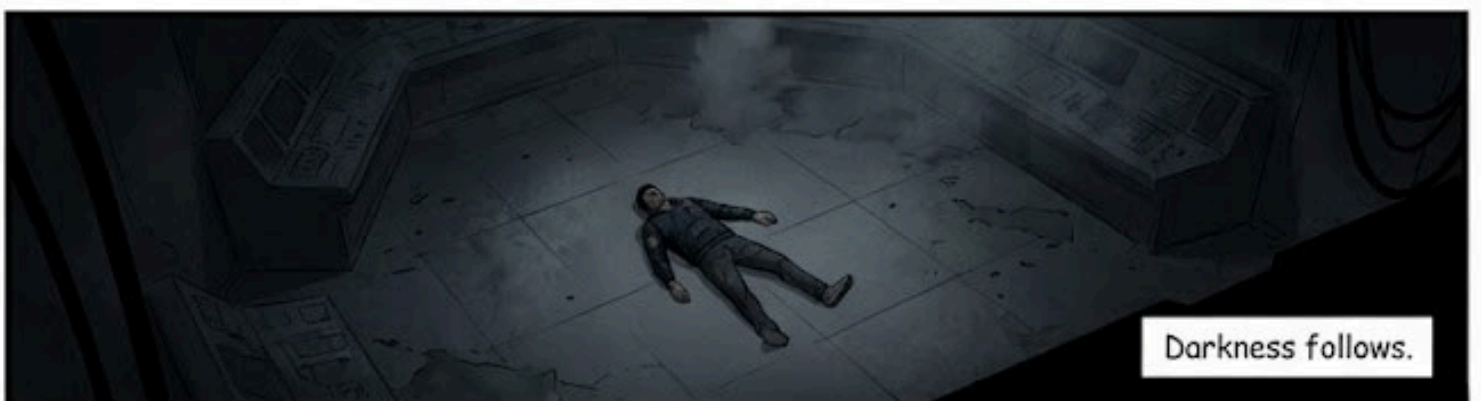
The threat ends.



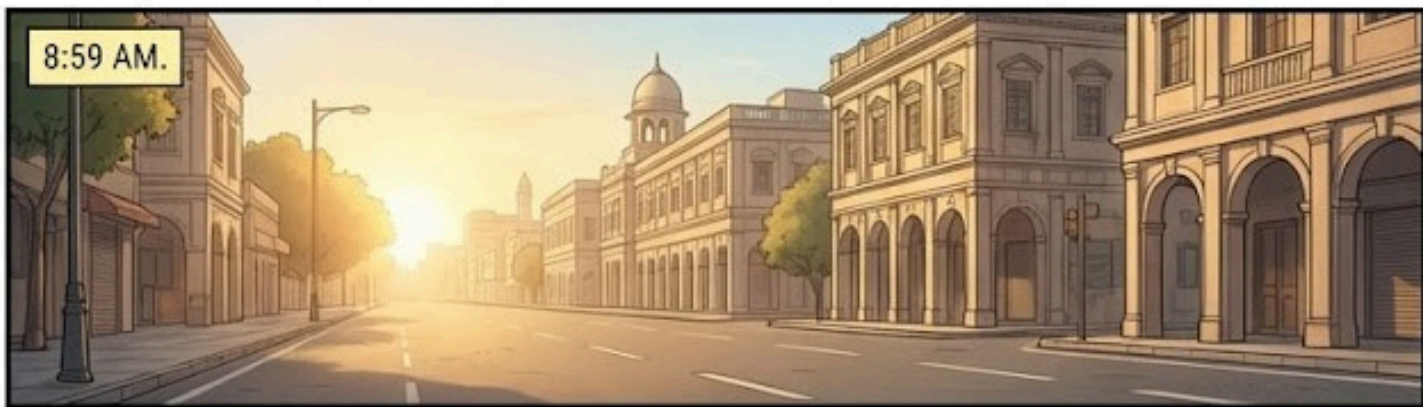
Aarav collapses.



Darkness follows.



8:59 AM.



No one knows what almost happened.



The parade continues.



History breathes again.



The Republic stands.





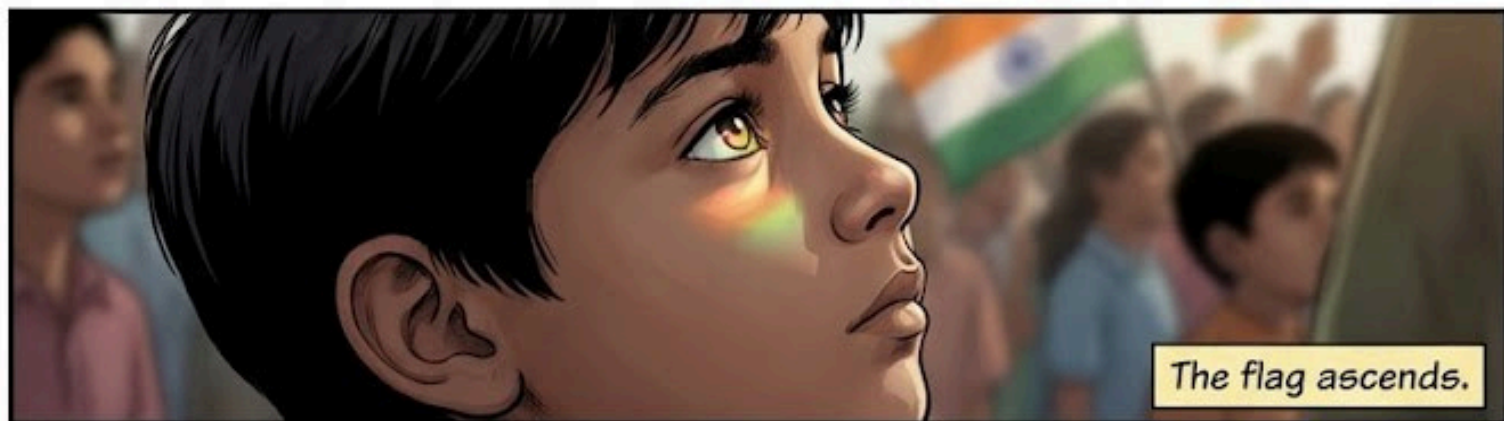
Drums roll.



Salutes rise.



Voices join as one.



The flag ascends.

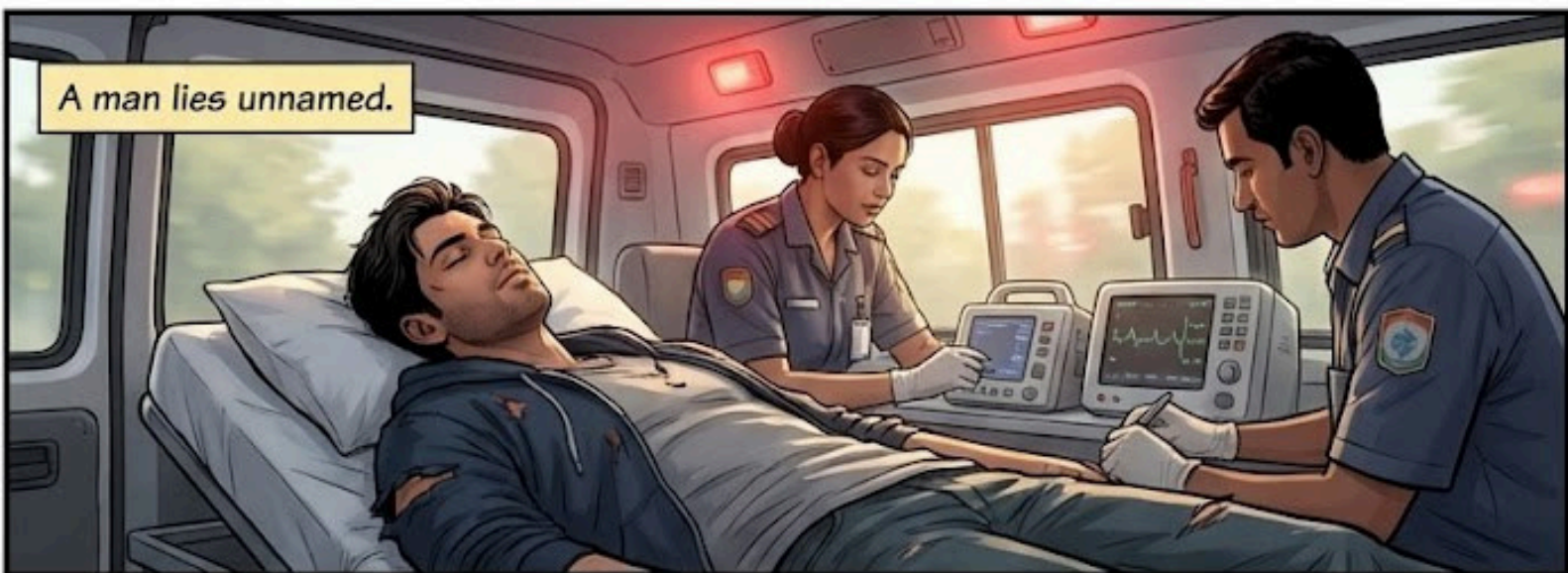


Higher than fear.

An ambulance moves quietly.



A man lies unnamed.



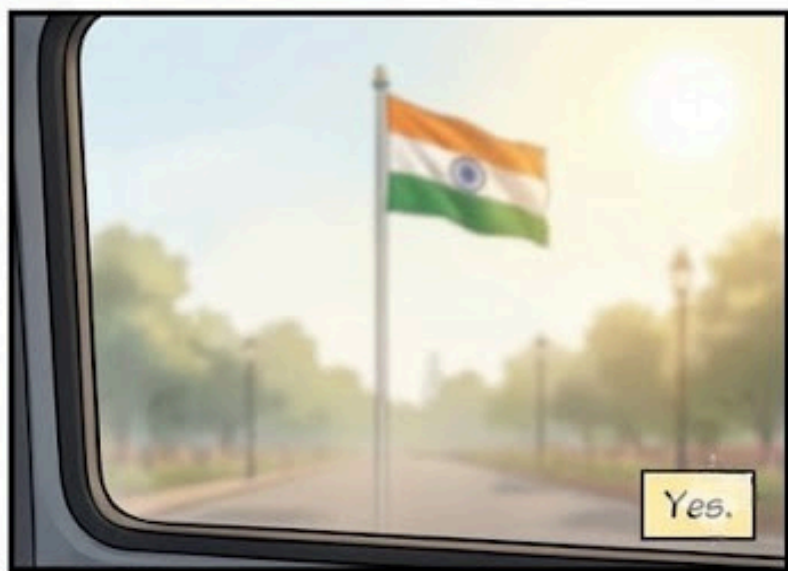
Did it
happen?



The flag answers.



Yes.





“The Republic doesn’t stand because it is powerful.
It stands because someone always chooses to.”